

After this chapter, you'll see a list of Scriptures dealing with the subject of credit. The minimum that Christians should do is to spend a few minutes a day looking at those Scriptures and studying them. If they do that a couple of times, they will begin to get the flavor of what God's Word has to say about credit. As I have said consistently, credit is not prohibited, but it must be used properly.

Is it necessary that we seek counsel from a Christian source?

Of great importance to a Christian is the admonition to avoid the direct counsel of the unsaved. That in no way implies that unsaved people can't give good financial counsel. However, their counsel is lacking the most essential element: God's Word. It has been my experience that most counsel from unsaved financial advisers is aimed at protecting the assets of their clients, and that is to be expected. But Christians must focus on the rights of the other parties involved before their own. To do otherwise limits the ability of God to intercede on our behalf. The Bible says, "Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make your paths straight" (Proverbs 3:5–6).

I believe the primary source of any counsel should be the local church. It's unfortunate that many churches aren't equipped to provide financial coaching for their people, though more are getting trained to do so every year. Usually there are Christian accountants, bankers, and businesspeople within the church who have the ability to help individuals with basic budgeting problems. If you need help, tell your pastor and ask him to refer you to someone in the church who can help on a volunteer basis. In general I have found that most people are willing to help and are even flattered by such a request. Most important, your request may stimulate the church to begin providing this needed ministry on a regular basis.

Our church wants to begin a financial ministry. Where do we start?